

Four Types of Coping Self-Statements for Stress Inoculation



1. Self-statements when preparing for a stressor	What do I have to do? I can create a plan to deal with this. Thinking about what I have to do is certainly better than getting nervous about it. Worrying won't help. Plan. My anxiety tells me that I have a challenge facing me. I can learn from this. Remain logical and calm.
2. Self-statements when confronting and handling the stressor	I can handle this. I can meet this challenge. Just take it one step at a time; follow the plan. Beat the fear: Think about what I am doing. Relax. I'm in control. Just take a slow, deep breath. My tension just tells me to follow my plan; deal with this challenge. I can eat sage foods as part of my plan.
3. Self-statements when coping with feelings at critical moments	When tension comes, just pause and breathe slowly. Focus on the present. Now, what do I have to do? I've handled this before and I can manage it now. I'll rate my fear from 1 to 10 and then watch it change. I'll just keep the tension manageable; I won't worry about eliminating it altogether. I can do this. It will be over in a certain amount of time. Okay, keep focused on what I want to do. This is not the worst thing that can happen. Remember, I don't have to handle this perfectly, just reasonably well. I'll focus on sensations: coldness, warmth, smells, touch, taste, sights, and sounds. I'm going to think about other times and places. Good feelings come with good thoughts. I'm in control.
4. Self-statements when rewarding yourself for successful coping	Nice going! I was able to do it. It wasn't as tough as I expected. Wait until I tell [a friend, a family member] about it. I'm making progress. My plan worked. I'm learning all the time. It's my thinking that creates anxiety. When I control my self-statements, I can control my anxiety. I'm doing better each time I use these self-statements. I'm really pleased with my progress.